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Executive Order.

In order to effect the more expeditious erection and completion of semi-permanent ward buildings, dining hall, kitchen and appurtenances at Saint Elizabeths Hospital in the District of Columbia in which to provide for the care and treatment of soldiers and sailors becoming mentally incompetent by reason of their service in the present war, the early completion of said buildings et cetera for the use of the activities of the Department of the Interior engaged on work in connection with war measures creating a National Emergency, and by virtue of the provisions of the Act of Congress approved March 4, 1917, entitled "An Act Making appropriations for the Naval Service for the Fiscal Year ending June 30, 1918, and for other purposes" (39 Stat., 1192), whereby, among other things, it is provided "That in case of National Emergency the President is authorized to suspend provisions of law prohibiting more than eight hours labor in any one day of persons engaged upon work covered by contracts with the United States: *Provided further*, That the wages of persons employed upon such contracts shall be computed on a basic day rate of eight hours work, with overtime rates to be paid for at not less than time and one-half for all hours work in excess of eight hours", I do hereby suspend the provisions of law prohibiting more than eight hours of labor in any one day by persons, firms or corporations engaged in the erection and completion of the above-mentioned buildings et cetera belonging to the United States at the Saint Elizabeths Hospital in the District of Columbia. This order will take effect from and after this date.

WOODROW WILSON

THE WHITE HOUSE,
24 May, 1918.

[No. 2865.]